

10.7 Use MPEG-4 H.264

Google Android has built-in hardware for video playback acceleration. Specifically the hardware is meant to give MPEG-4 H.264 file playback a much smoother return on your display. You can find the settings for MPEG-4 playback on the standard Google Android "Video Player" which unfortunately has to be downloaded from the Android Marketplace, as Android does not come equipped with a video player. On the other hand, the Video Player is free and downloads in a matter of seconds.

10.8 The Hard Search key

The little symbol on your Google Android front screen that looks like a magnifying glass will quickly bring you to the Google Search Page, which is a great feature for quick online searching, however the key can also be used for even further convenience. For instance, if you're on any Google web site, such as YouTube you can click on that same option and the program will then search that Google owned web site for any search term you type into the search box that appears.

Another great function of this feature is that it is a specific box for each app, for YouTube it may be just a typical search box, whereas for Google Maps you will be prompted for information pertaining to that program such as address, city, state and zip code.

For quick launch search functionality that's specific to Google web pages there really isn't anything better than the included search functionality of Google Android.

10.9 Other Tips

- Prefer not to be bothered by a sound every time an email arrives? Head into Gmail's Settings menu and set its ringtone to Silent. You'll still see new-message alerts in the notification panel at the top of your screen, and you can always pull the panel down to get detailed information. You can configure text messaging and other alert-generating apps the same way.
- Set up one-touch dialing for the people you call the most. Hold your finger on an open space and select Shortcuts. Then, touch Direct dial and pick the person from your contact list. If one-touch texting is what you crave, use the Direct message option instead.
- To drop your favourite web pages onto your home screen, long-press on any site in your browser's bookmarks and then select the Add shortcut to home option.